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Facial Expression Analysis: Post Processing face recordings

The following article will describe how to post-process face recordings for facial expressions in iMotions. Methods for both Affectiva AFFDEX and Emotient FACET will be described.

iMotions allows you to post-process videos by performing a facial expression analysis on pre-recorded videos. This is a very useful feature for post-processing videos that were shot off-site or recorded on devices that don't have iMotions installed.

1) Preparing Videos

iMotions batch-imports videos on a folder basis, not by individual files. Therefore, all the videos you want to post-import should be kept in a single folder. That folder should contain only those videos you want to process, and no other files.

File Formats: iMotions will only accept videos that are in .wmv or .mp4 format. WMV format is preferred. If your videos are in a different format, they will need to be converted. We've had success with the following video conversion tools:

- Any Video Converter
- VLC Media Player
- Handbrake

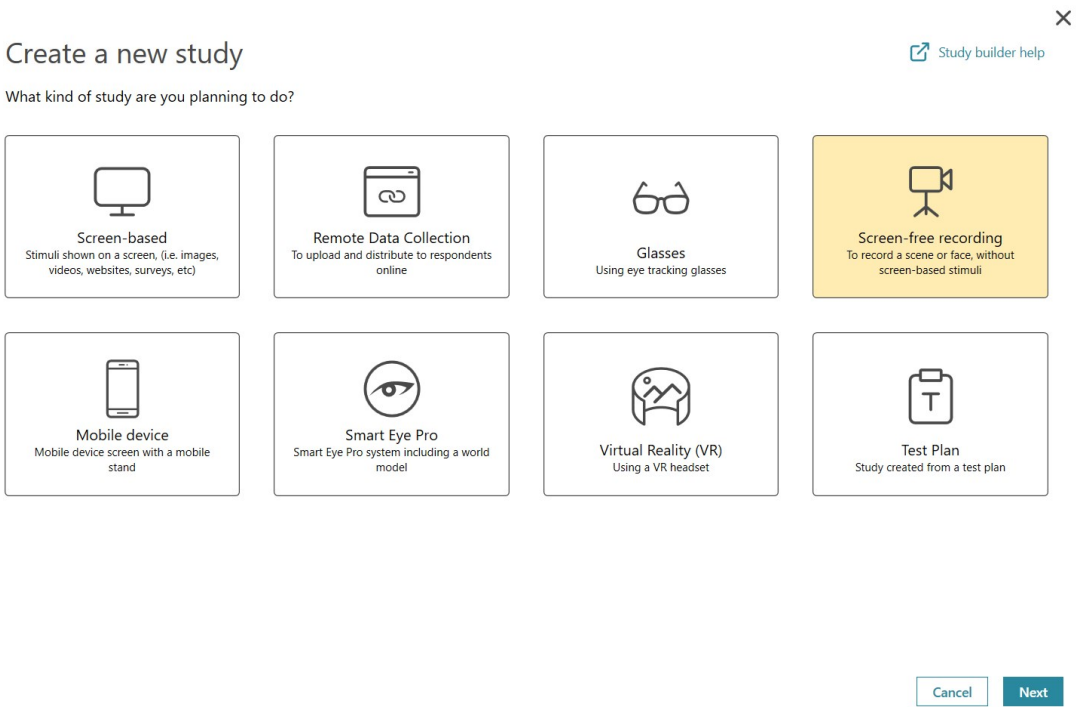
2) Creating Your Study

1. Create a new study.

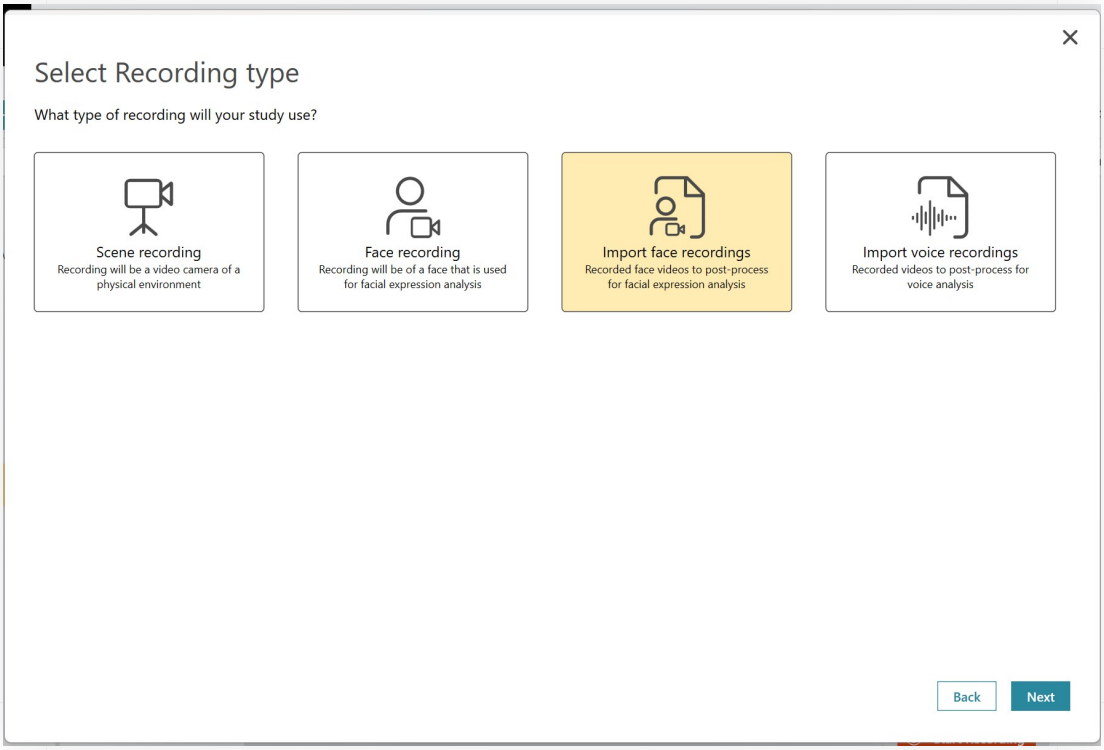


2. Select "screen-free recording", and click "Next"

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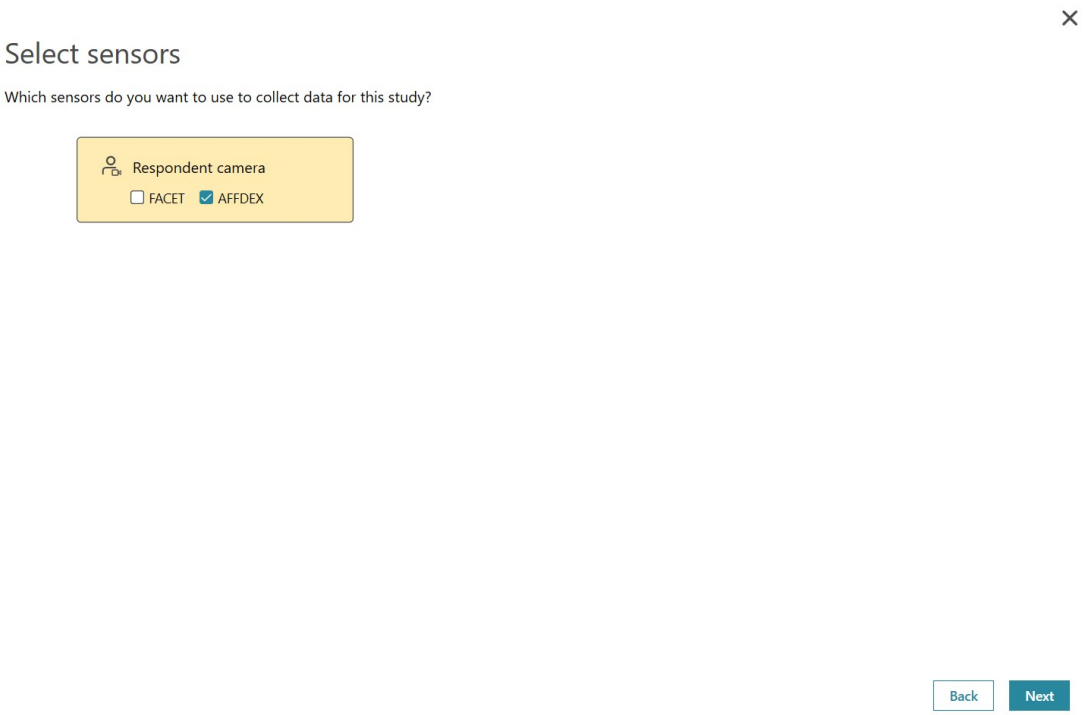


3. Select "import face recordings".

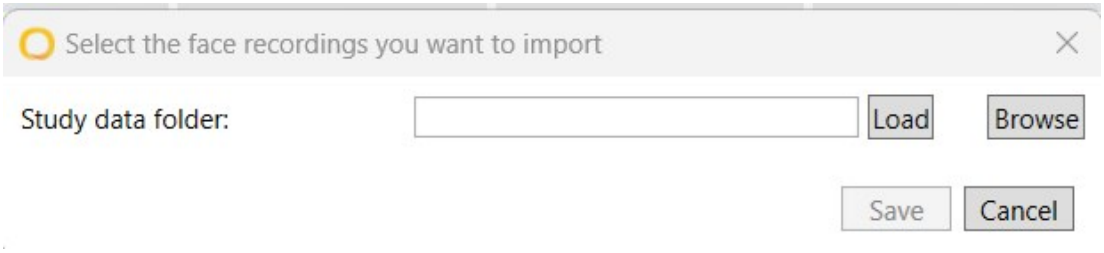


4. On the following page, select the relevant facial expression analysis methodology. Click next.

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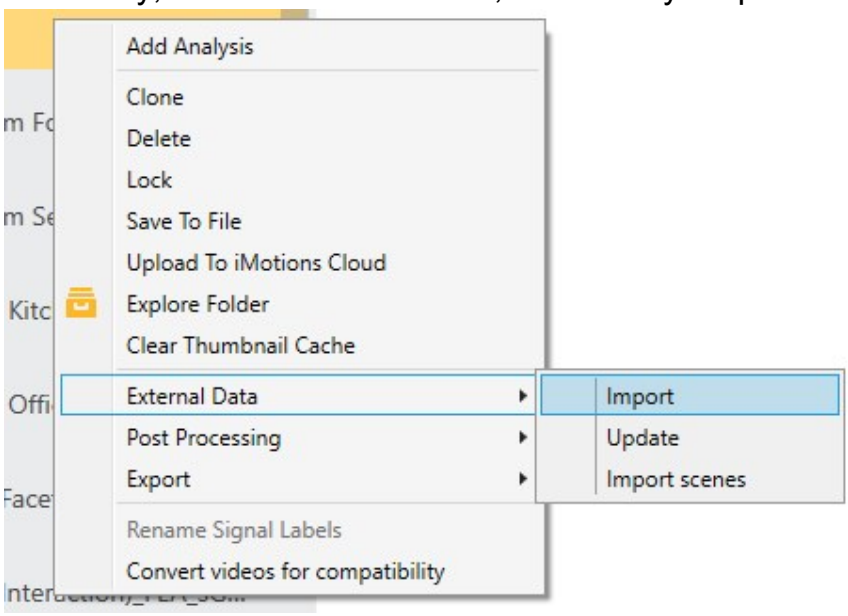
5. iMotions will now show a pop-up box. Click "browse" and find the folder containing the files that you would like to import. Once the folder is selected, click "load" and then "save".



3) Batch-Importing Data

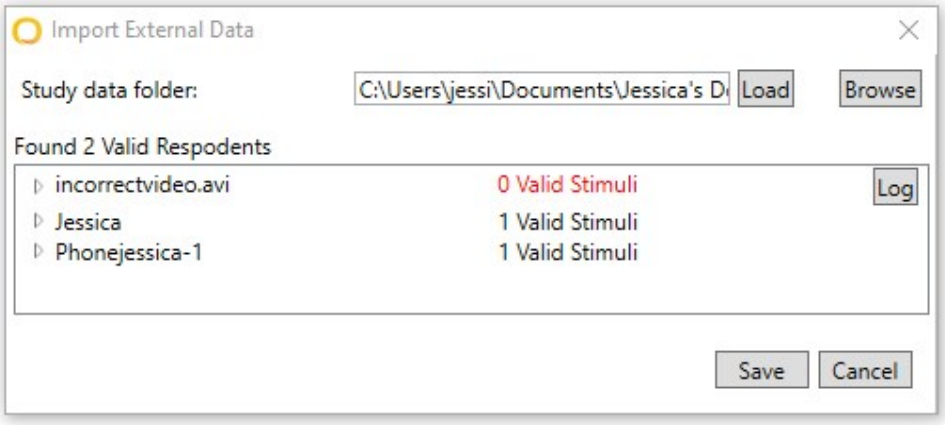
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1. To import a batch or group of videos together, right-click on your study in the Library, select "External Data", followed by "Import".

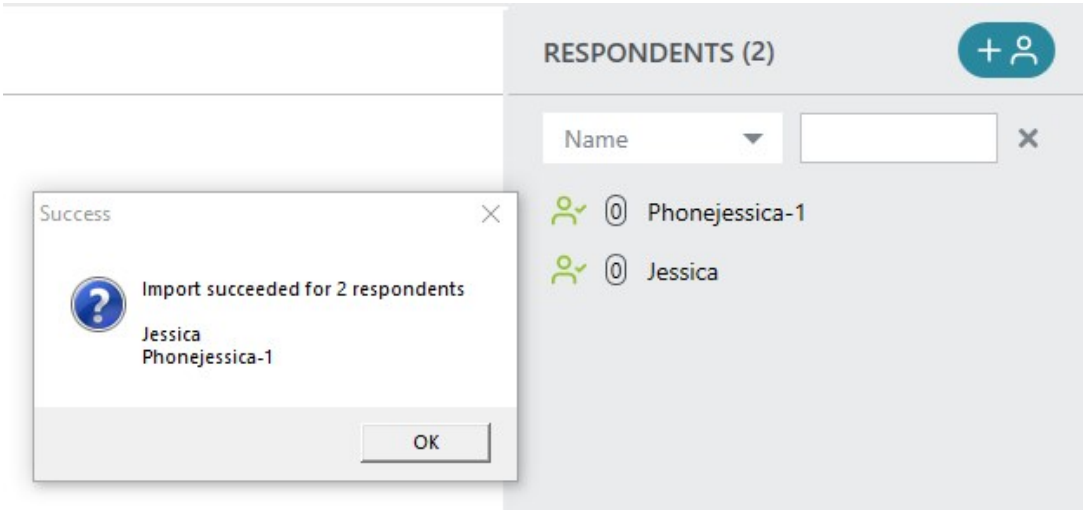


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2. After clicking, you will be prompted to input the file location: this is the folder you set up in Step 1 that contains only the videos you want to process. You can find this manually by clicking on the "browse" button or you can enter the file location if you already know it. Click "Load" once the folder address is identified.
   If the videos are in the right format, the dialog box will list each video as Valid Stimuli. Videos or any other files that are not readable by iMotions will be listed in red as Invalid.



   Click "Save". The videos will be imported into the iMotions study. Each video will be listed as a single respondent in the Respondents panel on the right.



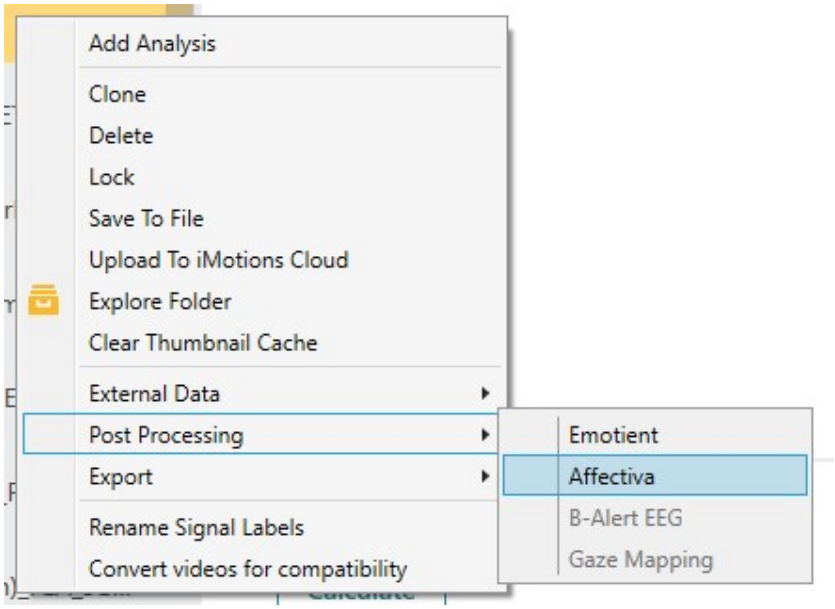
   If you click on each respondent, you will be able to view the imported video file, but there will not be any Facial Expression data. To analyze the video for facial expressions, you must Post-Process according to the engine you wish to use.

   If you are using Affdex, proceed to Step 4.
   If you are using FACET, proceed to Step 5.

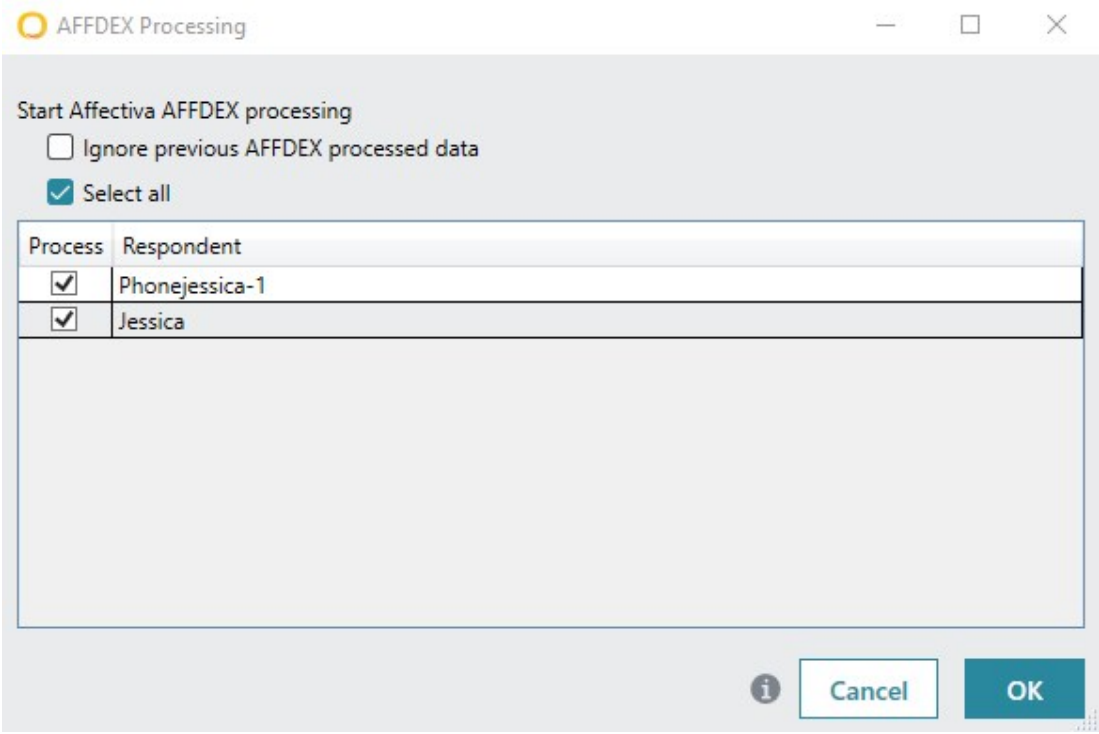
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4) Post-Processing with AFFDEX

1. To begin post-processing, right-click on your study in the Library, and select 'Post-Processing' followed by 'Affectiva'.



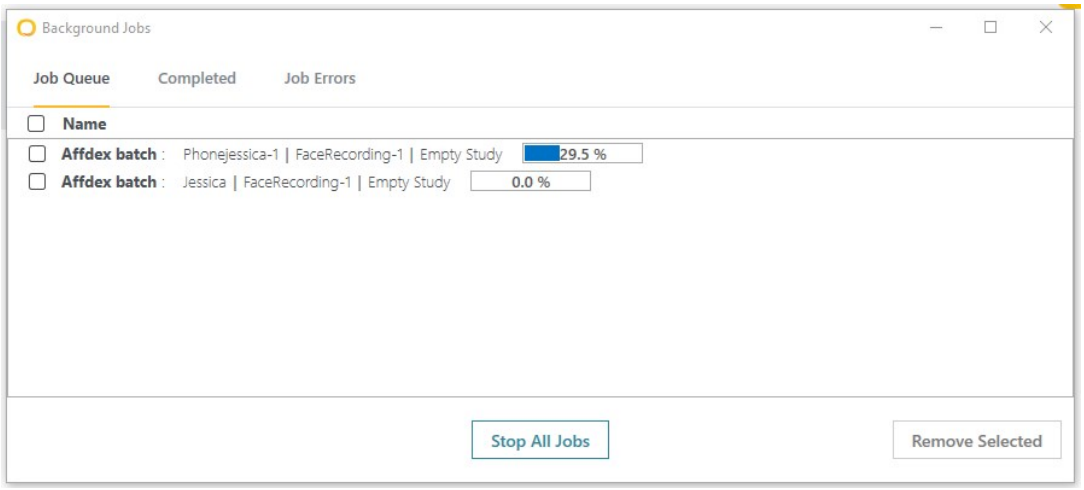
2. A dialog box will appear listing your respondent videos. Leave the sliding scale so that n = 1 (so that the engine will process every single frame). Select the videos you wish to post-process and click OK.



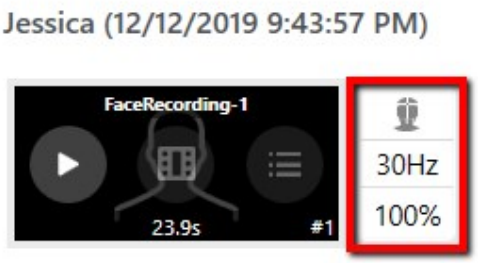
3. iMotions will now post-process each video, analyzing facial expressions for every frame. These videos are listed in Background Jobs, where you can monitor their progress and continue using the software while the

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videos are analyzed in the background. As a general rule, the time it takes to post-process a video is roughly the same as the duration of that video.

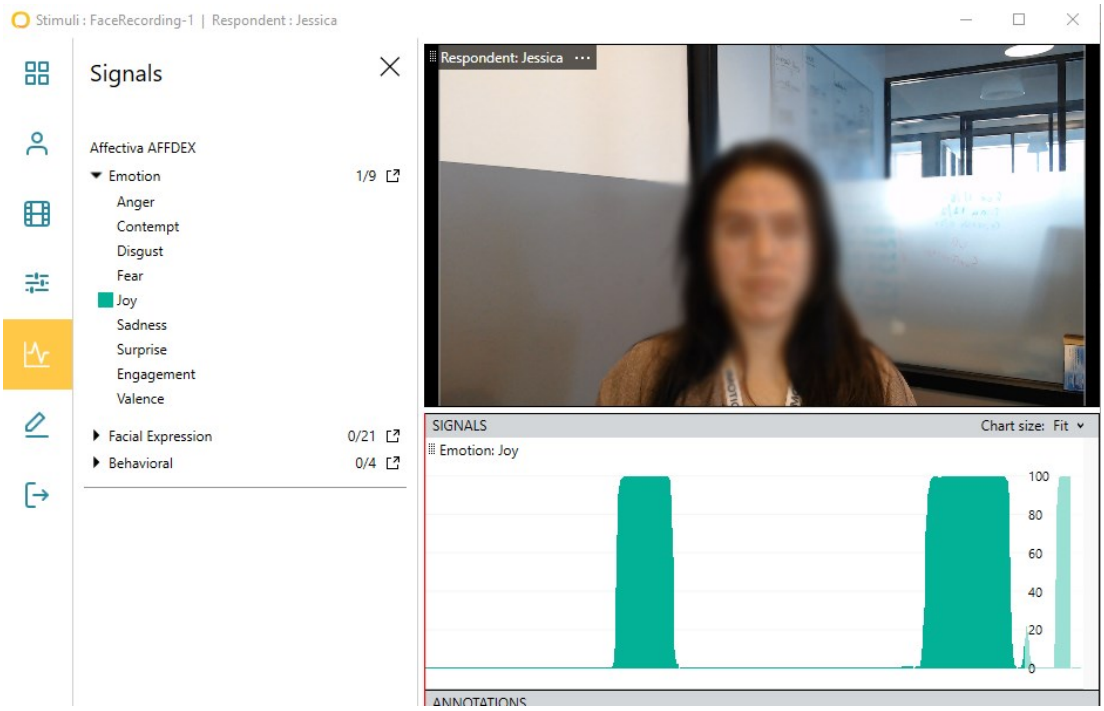


4. When videos have finished post-processing, Quality Metrics will accompany the recorded data replays when respondents are selected from the Respondent Panel. This metric is only representative of the percentage of frames successfully analyzed by iMotions and is not an indicator of overall accuracy or face quality.



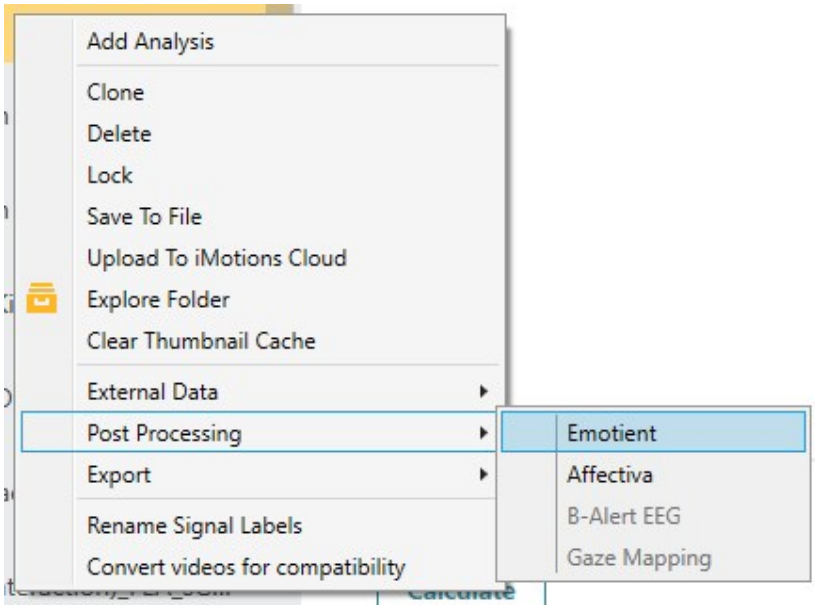
AFFDEX data will now be available in the Replay Editor.

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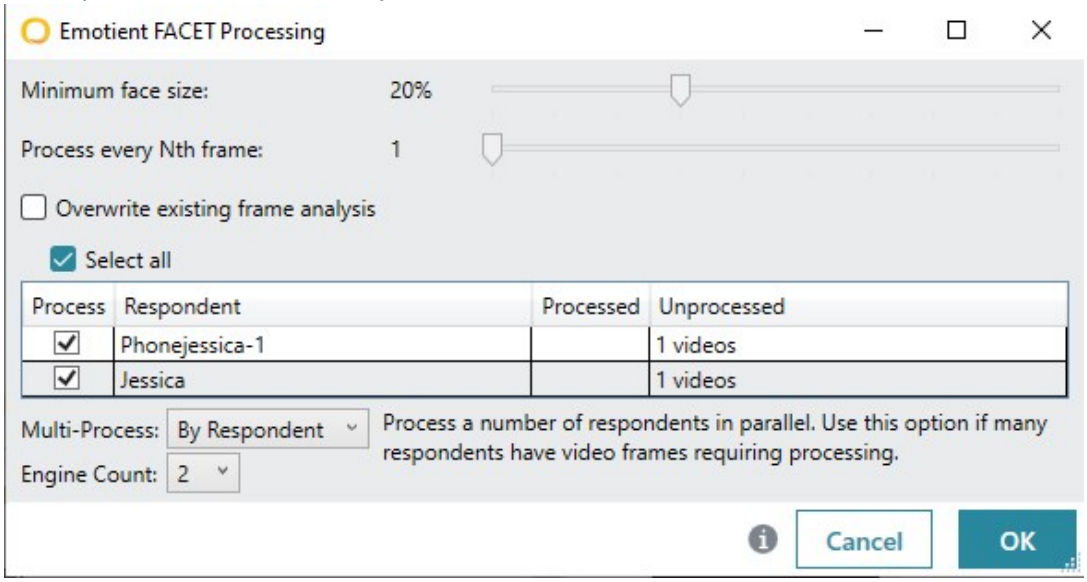
5) Post-Processing with FACET

1. To begin post-processing, right-click on your study in the Library, and select 'Post-Processing' followed by 'Emotient'.

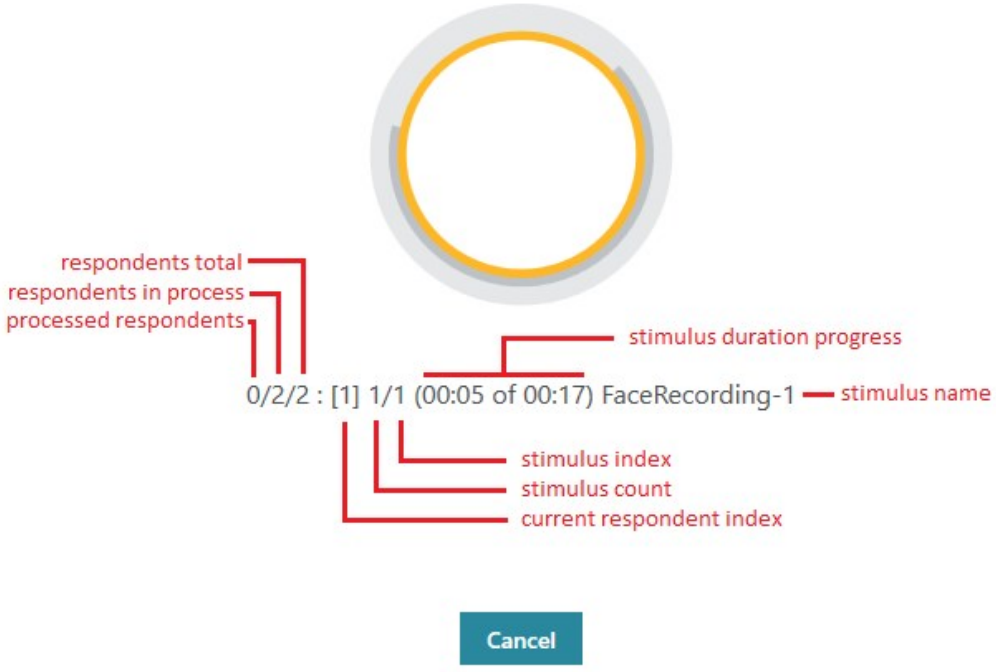


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2. A dialog box will appear listing your respondent videos. The first sliding scale pertains to the "Minimum Face Size", which refers to the size that the participant's face occupies about the size of the screen. Leave the sliding scale so that n = 1 (so that the engine will process every single frame). Select the videos you wish to post-process and click OK.



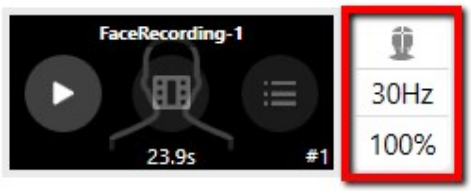
When you press OK, a progress screen will show up in the central panel showing the progress of the analysis.



3. When videos have finished post-processing, Quality Metrics will accompany the recorded data replays when respondents are selected from the Respondent Panel. This metric is only representative of the percentage of frames successfully analyzed by iMotions and is not an indicator of overall accuracy or face quality.

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Jessica (12/12/2019 9:43:57 PM)



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